

The 2026 Education, Workforce, and Training Opportunity Report

A field guide to districts, workforce boards, state agencies, funded providers, implementation partners, and training demand.

6 lanes District, workforce, grant, recipient, partner, and policy routes	30 days A practical first-market operating plan	2 layers Direct buyers and publicly funded implementers
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Built for founders and revenue teams that need credible targets, clear revenue motions, contact paths, and next actions - not a generic list of grants or contracts.

Opportunity Scanner by Opportunity Systems

Research current as of July 11, 2026. Always recheck time-sensitive official sources before acting.

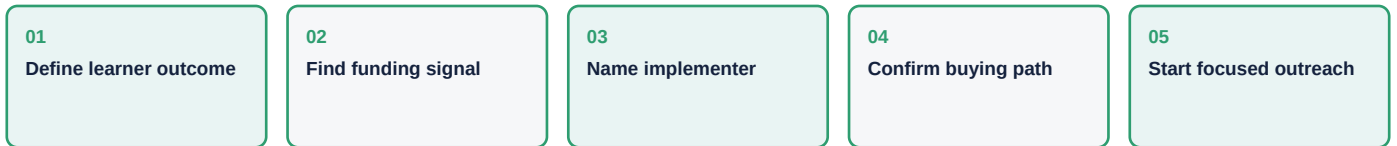
The opportunity landscape

Use these lanes to separate records that imply different buyers, partners, timing, and next actions.

Six evidence lanes to investigate



From signal to an owned revenue action



These diagrams are operating maps, not a promise that every lane is open. The report explains the evidence, constraints, and qualification checks behind each route.

Offer and audience

This report is for education technology companies, curriculum and training providers, staffing and workforce businesses, employer networks, assessment and credentialing companies, arts-education providers, community-based organizations, and revenue teams exploring public-sector growth.

Conversion promise: Learn how to identify where education and workforce priorities become grants, formula-funded programs, local purchasing, provider partnerships, and implementation work. The report does not determine eligibility, allowable cost, provider approval, procurement status, award likelihood, or revenue potential.

Executive brief

The education and workforce market is not a single buyer category. Federal agencies set policy, issue grants, and allocate formula funds; states write plans and distribute or administer money; local workforce boards, school districts, community colleges, training providers, and community organizations implement services. Employers may be customers, design partners, work-based-learning hosts, or beneficiaries. The useful opportunity can therefore sit several steps downstream from the federal announcement.

Strong July 2026 signals include WIOA allotments, modified 2026-27 state plans, estimated FY2026 Perkins V allocations, adult-education state funding, and apprenticeship records. They evidence active systems and priorities, not necessarily open competitions or vendor market size.

The commercial advantage comes from tracing money and responsibility. A state allotment points to local planning; a plan names priorities and structures; a local record may reveal a purchasing route; and an award may reveal a funded buyer or partner. A school or district dataset defines the market but does not prove purchasing intent. Opportunity Scanner should preserve those differences and the next validation task.

State of the market in July 2026

Trend 1: Program Year 2026 money is moving through established workforce systems

On April 28, 2026, DOL issued TEGL 10-25 with Program Year 2026 allotments for WIOA Adult, Dislocated Worker, and Youth activities, Wagner-Peyser Employment Service, and Workforce Information Grants.

Business implication: The federal guidance is a money-flow signal, not a federal solicitation for vendors. The practical targets are state workforce agencies, local workforce development boards, American Job Center operators, contracted service providers, and partners identified in state and local plans.

Recommended action: Select a geography, read its current plan and allocation attachment, then look for local implementation plans, board minutes, requests for proposals, eligible-provider processes, and incumbent contracts.

Trend 2: State plans are current strategic intelligence, not ceremonial documents

DOL guidance for WIOA Program Years 2026 and 2027 required states to modify their Unified or Combined State Plans. DOL's WIOA resources page links to approved plans and explains that the plans coordinate core programs. State performance pages also publish the most recent results, currently Program Year 2024 reports as of this report's date.

Business implication: Plans can expose priority industries, populations, regional structure, employer needs, and planned changes before a purchase appears. Performance reports can test a problem hypothesis, but reported outcomes lag current operations.

Recommended action: Convert plan language into a target hypothesis. For example, a plan emphasizing youth work experience may support outreach to the local board or youth provider; it does not prove that either is buying software now.

Trend 3: Career and technical education is a state-to-local opportunity lane

The U.S. Department of Education's Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education publishes estimated FY2026 Perkins V state allocations. Its allocation page says Congress appropriates approximately \$1.4 billion each year in Title I state formula grant funds. A February 4, 2026 program memorandum set requirements for state plan revisions and budgets associated with FY2026 awards.

Business implication: The national figure is program context, not vendor demand. States determine secondary and postsecondary distribution and reserve or leadership uses within the statute and approved plans. The likely targets may be state education agencies, eligible agencies, school districts, area career centers, community colleges, consortia, or funded partners.

Recommended action: Follow the federal allocation to the state CTE plan, then to state allocation tables, local applications, approved recipients, and purchasing rules. Verify whether the proposed product or service is an allowable and prioritized use.

Trend 4: Adult education creates buyer and partner routes beyond school districts

Education Department guidance states that Adult Education and Family Literacy Act basic grants go to eligible state agencies, which then fund local providers. Potential local providers include local education agencies, community-based and faith-based organizations, higher education institutions, libraries, public housing authorities, nonprofits, consortia, and qualifying employer partnerships.

Business implication: Adult literacy, integrated education and training, workplace literacy, and English language programs can create application, partner, subcontract, and funded-buyer paths. The route depends on state rules, demonstrated effectiveness, and eligibility.

Recommended action: Find the state administrator, current local competition or provider list, program priorities, and grant period. Treat an existing provider as a potential buyer or partner only after confirming its funded scope.

Trend 5: Short-term training and apprenticeship are visible priorities, but timing matters

DOL listed Strengthening Community Colleges Round 6 for short-term training and workforce-system integration; it ran February 17-May 20, 2026. Apprenticeship dashboards show program, participant, state, and grant-performance views; the state dashboard notes data through March 18, 2026 and coverage limitations.

Business implication: A closed grant is no longer a direct-application lead, but its awards can become Sell to Award Recipient or Partner with Recipient signals. Apprenticeship dashboards describe activity, not vendor demand.

Recommended action: Monitor award announcements, validate project scope and period, identify consortium members and implementation gaps, and distinguish Registered Apprenticeship evidence from looser uses of the word "apprenticeship."

Trend 6: Better public data increases targeting precision but does not establish intent

The National Center for Education Statistics released the 2024-25 Common Core of Data Universe Files, Version 1a, in December 2025. The files contain state-, district-, and school-level attributes, staff counts, enrollment, and selected student characteristics. DOL publishes Program Year 2024 WIOA performance reports and reporting definitions.

Business implication: These datasets can support territory design, peer comparison, and account research. They should not be converted into claims about need, budget, or intent without additional evidence.

Recommended action: Use data to narrow accounts, then require a current plan, budget, board record, procurement notice, grant award, job posting, or source-native contact path before labeling a row actionable.

Education and workforce opportunity-lane map

Lane	What the evidence looks like	Likely target	Typical Revenue Motion	First validation
State and local workforce delivery	WIOA allotment, state plan, local plan, board agenda, operator RFP	State agency, local workforce board, American Job Center operator	Sell to Agency; Sell to Funded Buyer	Geography, program year, local control, procurement route
K-12 and district procurement	District plan, budget, board packet, state contract, bid portal notice	District, school, education service agency, state education agency	Sell to Agency; Channel / Distributor Motion	Active need, budget owner, cooperative or bid route
Perkins V and CTE	State allocation, CTE plan, local recipient list, equipment or program notice	District, area CTE center, community college, consortium	Sell to Funded Buyer; Partner with Recipient	Secondary/postsecondary split, allowable use, recipient status
Adult education and literacy	State competition, provider award, integrated education and training plan	State administrator, local provider, college, library, nonprofit	Direct Apply; Sell to Award Recipient; Partner with Recipient	Eligibility, demonstrated effectiveness, grant period, service scope

Lane	What the evidence looks like	Likely target	Typical Revenue Motion	First validation
Community college and sector training	Federal or state award, college RFP, consortium announcement	College, system office, workforce intermediary, employer consortium	Sell to Award Recipient; Partner with Recipient	Award status, consortium role, implementation need
Registered Apprenticeship	Program registration, grant record, sponsor directory, performance dashboard	Sponsor, intermediary, labor-management organization, college, employer	Sell to Funded Buyer; Partner with Recipient	Registration status, occupation, sponsor authority, funding source
Workforce grants for priority populations	DOL notice or award for youth, tribal, farmworker, reentry, older-worker, or dislocated-worker services	Eligible applicant, grantee, subrecipient, service operator	Direct Apply; Sell to Award Recipient; Partner with Recipient	Eligibility, deadline, population, geography, allowable activities
Policy, data, and future demand	Federal guidance, plan modification, performance report, labor-market analysis	Policy owner, state agency, board, research or data office	Monitor Policy; Research Only	Effective date, data period, operational consequence

A qualification framework that prevents false positives

Score each dimension High, Medium, or Low. Do not add the labels into a precise numeric score unless the product has validated weights against real outcomes.

Dimension	High-confidence evidence	Downgrade or reject when
Offer fit	The source describes a use case, population, workflow, or deliverable the company serves	Relevance depends on broad terms such as "education," "skills," or "students" alone
Money status	Active notice, current allotment, active project period, adopted budget, or current procurement	A request, proposal, old award, or broad appropriation is presented as available money
Target clarity	One agency, board, district, college, provider, grantee, or sponsor controls the next step	The row names only a federal program or an entire state
Buyer role	Purchasing, grantmaking, implementation, or partnership authority is supported	A school, employer, or nonprofit is assumed to buy because it appears in a dataset
Eligibility and route	Applicant or vendor route is documented and realistic	Registration, provider eligibility, match, experience, geography, or procurement constraints are unknown
Timing	Deadline, project period, program year, and amendment status are verified	The deadline passed or the source has no current date
Contact path	Official program contact, procurement office, board staff, recipient lead, or portal exists	The only route is an unverified personal email
Next action	One task can validate need, authority, route, or fit within days	The action is generic outreach or "research more"

High Actionability requires strong offer fit, current money or procurement evidence, a named target, a viable route, and a concrete next action. Medium Actionability has a plausible path but one material unknown. Low Actionability is market context, an expired route, or a weak match. A closed grant with a newly announced recipient can still be Medium or High for a recipient-sale motion; it is Low for Direct Apply.

Source-to-action table

Official source	What it can prove	What it cannot prove	Best Opportunity Scanner action
DOL WIOA allotment guidance	Current federal allocations by program and state	Local buying intent or vendor eligibility	Open state plan and trace funds to local areas

Official source	What it can prove	What it cannot prove	Best Opportunity Scanner action
WIOA State Plan Portal	Approved priorities, structure, sectors, populations, and partner roles	A purchase, open grant, or local execution detail	Extract named priorities and identify controlling agencies or boards
DOL performance reports	Reported outcomes under defined measures for a past program year	Current performance or the cause of an outcome	Form a problem hypothesis and validate locally
Education Department Perkins allocations	Estimated state formula allocations and program context	Local amount, allowable purchase, or recipient demand	Follow state plan and distribution records
State CTE or adult-education pages	Competitions, plans, local awards, and provider rules when published	Automatic eligibility or future continuation	Verify open status and recipient scope
Apprenticeship.gov dashboards	Registered program and grant-performance context, subject to coverage notes	Vendor demand or complete data for every state	Identify sponsors and validate through state or sponsor sources
NCES Common Core of Data	School and district identity and reported attributes for a stated year	Need, budget availability, or intent	Enrich and segment accounts; do not create a lead without another signal
SAM.gov and Grants.gov	Federal notice status, dates, amendments, and source contacts	Award probability or downstream purchase	Confirm status, then choose Direct Apply, Sell to Agency, or monitor
USAspending	Federal award, recipient, agency, amount fields, and period data	Open opportunity or current buying intent	Treat as money-flow evidence and research the recipient
State/local bid and board portals	Local solicitations, awards, agendas, budgets, and approvals	Federal program eligibility beyond the record	Preserve the exact record and assign the official response route

The repeatable Opportunity Scanner workflow

Step 1: Build a precise company profile

Record the offer, population, buyer history, implementation model, outcomes, geography, integrations, accessibility, security, pricing, staffing needs, and approvals. Mark unknowns. A staffing marketplace, curriculum product, and case-management platform should not run the same searches.

Step 2: Translate the offer into public missions

Map commercial language to outcomes such as credential attainment, work-based learning, teacher or substitute staffing, adult literacy, integrated education and training, employer engagement, participant support, data reporting, CTE equipment, youth work experience, or apprenticeship completion. Add occupations, populations, and geographies.

Step 3: Search from federal signal to local control

Start with the lane-appropriate official source. For formula funding, trace federal allocation to state plan to local allocation or competition. For competitive grants, inspect the notice and then awards. For district sales, use official plans, budgets, board materials, and procurement portals. For apprenticeship, verify the sponsor and program status.

Step 4: Classify the evidence

Label the record active opportunity, current funding route, awarded recipient, historical market evidence, policy signal, account data, or research only. Record the source's own date and data period. Never let a closed notice retain a Direct Apply action.

Step 5: Name the target and money controller

Identify both the organization and its role: state administrator, local board, district procurement office, college grantee, lead consortium member, training provider, sponsor, employer partner, or incumbent vendor. The organization benefiting from a program may not control purchasing.

Step 6: Choose one Revenue Motion

Use Direct Apply only when the company is eligible and the notice is open. Use Sell to Agency for an actual government buying route. Use Sell to Funded Buyer or Sell to Award Recipient after validating the recipient's scope. Use Partner with Recipient for consortium or delivery alignment. Use Channel / Distributor Motion where a cooperative contract, reseller, prime, or approved-provider relationship is the practical route. Use Monitor Policy or Research Only when no current commercial action is supported.

Step 7: Create a contact path and next best action

Prefer the source contact, procurement office, program administrator, board staff, college grants office, employer-engagement lead, sponsor contact, vendor portal, or recipient program lead. The first message should test fit and process, not imply that public funding is unrestricted. Attach the source and assign one task with an owner and due date.

Worked illustrative example

Company context: A platform helps community colleges coordinate employer-backed short-term training, work-based learning, and participant follow-up.

Signal: A closed federal Strengthening Community Colleges Round 6 notice describes capacity building for short-term training and workforce-system integration. A later official award record names a college-led consortium in the company's service region.

Interpretation: The notice is no longer an application opportunity. The award is money-flow evidence. The college may be a funded buyer, partner, or neither, depending on the approved scope, budget, procurement method, and existing technology.

Primary motion: Partner with Recipient or Sell to Award Recipient.

Contact path: Project director or grants office listed by the college, followed by the procurement route if a product need is confirmed.

Next action: Obtain the official project summary, identify consortium roles and existing systems, and ask whether employer coordination or participant follow-up remains an implementation gap. This example is illustrative and does not claim that any recipient is currently buying.

30-day action plan

Week 1: Define and map

Complete the company profile. Select two lanes, two geographies, and no more than six search concepts. Identify the relevant state WIOA plan, CTE plan, adult-education administrator, district or college systems, and official procurement portals.

Week 2: Build an evidence-backed target set

Collect 15 to 20 records. Require an official URL, record date, status, target, and source limitation. Separate active notices from allotments, awards, plans, and account data. Reject generic keyword matches.

Week 3: Qualify and route

Score the top 10 records with the framework. Choose one Revenue Motion and contact path per row. Move only the strongest five into workflow. For funded recipients, read the project scope before outreach; for agency opportunities, confirm amendments and vendor requirements.

Week 4: Act and learn

Complete five validation actions: procurement inquiry, partner conversation, provider-route check, board or budget review, or source-contact question. Record validated, contacted, monitoring, rejected, or waiting. Feed rejection reasons into the next scan so volume does not outrun quality.

Caveats and responsible use

- This report is not legal, grant, procurement, education, accessibility, labor, or eligibility advice.
- Formula allotments are not vendor budgets. State and local rules determine distribution and use.
- Estimated allocations can change; use final award and state records when available.
- A plan states strategy but does not guarantee a solicitation or purchase.
- Performance data lag current operations and use defined reporting populations and measures.
- NCES account data do not prove need, available budget, or buying intent.
- Apprenticeship.gov coverage can vary by state; review dashboard notes and state-agency records.
- A funded college, district, provider, or nonprofit is not automatically a buyer.
- Closed notices are not Direct Apply opportunities, even when project activity continues.
- Recheck official sources before outreach, partnership commitments, applications, or bids.

Evidence and source ledger

Claim or use	Official primary source	Retrieval date	Caveat
PY2026 WIOA, Wagner-Peyser, and workforce-information allotment guidance issued April 28, 2026	U.S. Department of Labor, official source	2026-07-11	State allotments do not establish local buying intent.
PY2026-27 state-plan modification context and approved-plan route	U.S. Department of Labor, official source	2026-07-11	Plans describe strategy; implementation and procurement require local verification.
Current WIOA guidance and provider-eligibility guidance library	U.S. Department of Labor, official source	2026-07-11	Guidance is program-specific and should be read with current state rules.
Most recent state performance reports are PY2024	U.S. Department of Labor, official source	2026-07-11	Historical reported performance, not current operations or causal evidence.
Estimated FY2026 Perkins V state allocations and approximately \$1.4B annual Title I context	U.S. Department of Education OCTAE, official source	2026-07-11	National context is not vendor market size; allocations are labeled estimated.
FY2026 Perkins state-plan revision and budget instructions dated February 4, 2026	U.S. Department of Education, official source	2026-07-11	Administrative guidance does not prove a local purchase.
Adult education state grants and eligible local-provider types	U.S. Department of Education, official source	2026-07-11	State competitions, demonstrated-effectiveness rules, and award periods vary.
SCC Round 6 focus and February 17-May 20, 2026 notice dates	U.S. Department of Labor, official source	2026-07-11	Closed for direct application as of this report; monitor official awards.
Apprenticeship data tools and grant-performance route	Apprenticeship.gov, official source	2026-07-11	Dashboard coverage and reporting periods vary; not proof of vendor demand.
Apprentices-by-state data through March 18, 2026 and state coverage notes	Apprenticeship.gov, official source	2026-07-11	Some state data are incomplete or maintained outside RAPIDS.
2024-25 school and district universe data released December 2025	National Center for Education Statistics, official source	2026-07-11	Account and segmentation data, not need or buying intent.
Federal workforce program and American Job Center context	U.S. Department of Labor, official source	2026-07-11	Program overview; local operator and service structures must be verified.

Put this guide to work

Opportunity Scanner reads your company website, finds source-backed public-sector signals, and translates them into target organizations, revenue motions, contact paths, and next actions.

Run a free company scan at opportunityscanner.ai

Recheck official sources before any outreach, application, registration, or bid decision.